

Winter 2026

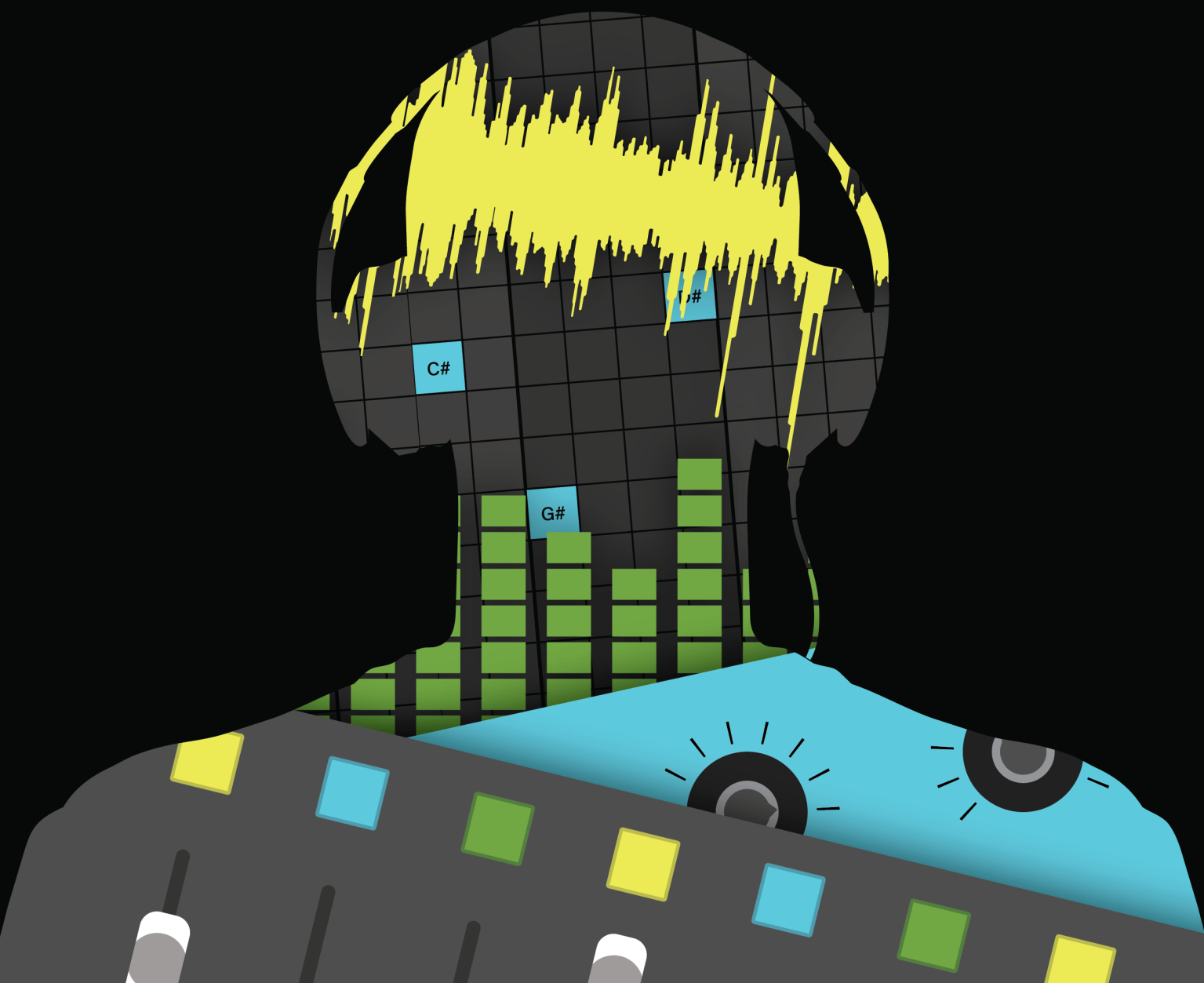
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MAGNETIC

MAGAZINE

THE VOICE OF PROGRESSIVE MUSIC CULTURE.



About Us

Magnetic Magazine is an online publication specializing in music and culture featuring interviews, premieres, mixes, charts, gear reviews, industry news, op-eds, and more. Magnetic focuses on the cutting edge and is the perfect intersection of electronic, indie, and hip-hop.

Founded in 2011 by BPM Magazine founder/publisher, David Ireland, and editor Rob Simas, Magnetic was designed to move in real-time. The content is an ever-evolving amalgamation of what our editorial team considers to be fresh, disruptive, and inspiring.

Magnetic delves deeper into the notions and politics of what modern music has become and what's next. The perfect junction between culture and music, diving into topics such as sustainability, travel, camping, and festival life.

The seasoned voice within these cultures featuring journalists that have been there since the beginning, while also giving fresh perspectives from a new crop of opinion leaders. The future is being written, and Magnetic was created to document it. We'd like it very much if you'd join us. Become part of our dialogue.

Observe. Report. Experience.





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HOW TO WRITE AN AMAZING HOOK

**IN MUSIC PRODUCTION
BY BRINGING IT BACK TO THE BASICS**

By Will Vance
Image from Magnetic Magazine

When I talk about hooks with electronic music producers, I usually start with a simple truth: the hook is the part of the track people remember, hum, or wait for when it comes back around. In a streaming-driven environment, that matters more than ever, because most listeners decide very quickly if they are staying with a song or skipping to the next one. I have found that the first ten to twenty seconds carry a lot of weight, especially on platforms where attention is fragmented and choice is endless.

For electronic producers, hooks serve an additional role that often gets overlooked. Many tracks begin as loops, and loops can feel endless if there is no clear destination. A strong hook gives that loop purpose and it becomes the point everything else leads toward, which makes it easier to expand an eight-bar idea into a full arrangement without losing focus. Instead of stacking layers randomly, the hook gives you something concrete to build around.

Streaming mechanics also shape how hooks function today. On major platforms, a listener has

Hooks capture attention quickly, which is essential in a streaming environment where listeners decide within seconds if a track earns their time.

to stay for at least thirty seconds before a play counts, and an engaging hook early in the arrangement helps carry them past that threshold naturally. This does not mean rushing everything into the intro, but it does mean being intentional about when and how your main idea appears.

What Is a Hook in a Song

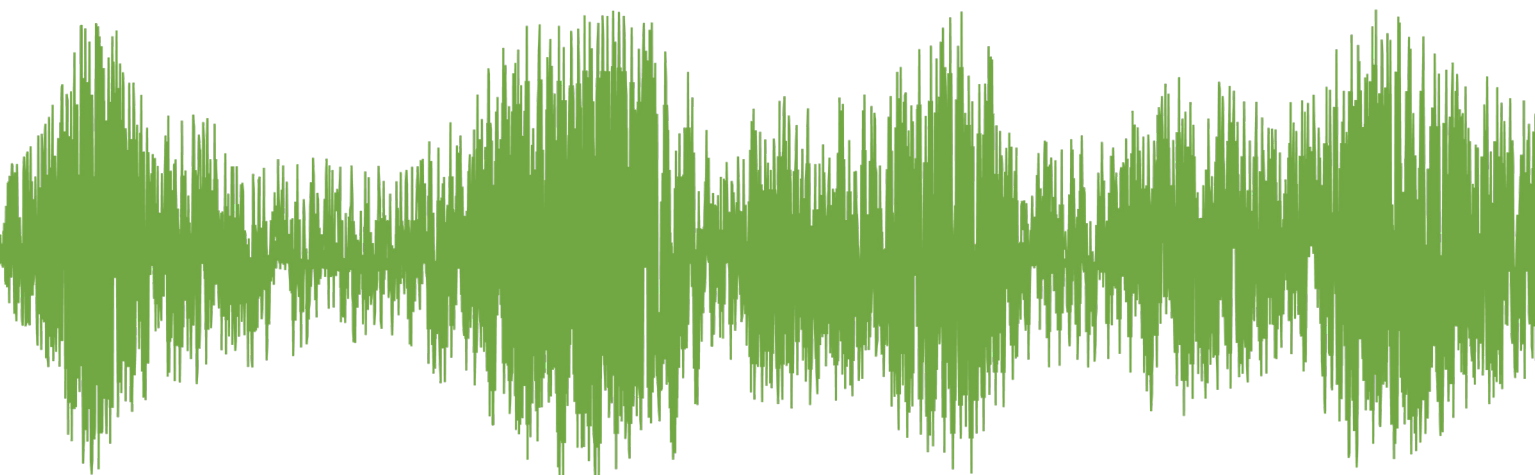
The hook often defines the identity of a track. It might be a vocal phrase, a synth line, or a guitar figure, but it is usually the element that makes a song recognizable within moments. With modern attention spans being what they are, the beginning of a track needs to present a compelling motif quickly, or at least hint at one that is about to arrive.

Hooks also drive replay value. When listeners hit repeat, that behavior feeds directly into streaming performance and long-term reach. In electronic genres,

hooks can come from many places, including vocal samples, synth leads, or production techniques like filter automation or modulation movement. That flexibility gives producers room to develop signatures that feel personal rather than formulaic.

Let's take a look at the various different types of hooks you can lean on from a bird's eye view. The whole point of this is to showcase and have a quick reference for the different hooks you can use in your own tracks that are apart from just an incredibly catchy melody. Anything can be a hook as long as it's got that signature ear-worm quality.

MELODIC HOOKS are what most people think of first. These are short note sequences that are easy to remember and repeat. They often rely on limited note choices and clear rhythmic placement, which makes them easy to recall even after a single listen.



Dance Music Songs With Great Hooks

Location – Khalid

The space in the intro creates tension, and I have found that the delayed arrival of the vocal hook makes it hit harder when it finally lands. Silence and restraint do a lot of the work here.

Harder, Better, Faster, Stronger – Daft Punk

The repeated vocal processing turns simple words into a rhythmic and textural motif. This track is a great example of how production choices alone can create a hook that carries an entire arrangement.

Happy – Pharrell Williams

The hook relies on a short, repeated phrase that stays front and center throughout the song. I like how the simplicity keeps it accessible while the rhythm underneath gives it momentum.

Line of Sight – ODESZA

The hook shows up early in a filtered form, which sets expectations without giving everything away. When the full version arrives later, the contrast adds lift and makes the moment feel earned.

Alberto Balsam – Aphex Twin

This track proves that a hook does not need constant variation to hold attention. The repeating synth phrase stays steady while other elements move around it, which turns the hook into an anchor rather than a focal peak.

Nightcall – Kavinsky

The opening sound design sets the tone before any music even starts, and that intro becomes inseparable from the track itself. By the time the synth line enters, the atmosphere has already done half the work of pulling you in.

Levels – Avicii

The synth line in this track hits fast and stays consistent, and I have found that its four-bar cycle makes it easy to latch onto without needing anything complicated around it. The rhythm and pitch sit in a sweet spot where you recognize it instantly, even if you hear it out of context.

Summer – Calvin Harris

This hook works because the synth motif and vocal phrase reinforce each other instead of competing, which gives the track a clear center. I like how the repetition feels natural rather than forced, especially once the chorus locks in with the groove.

Get Lucky – Daft Punk

The guitar riff starts early and never really leaves, and that consistency turns it into the track's calling card. It functions rhythmically and melodically at the same time, which is why you recognize the song within seconds.

RHYTHMIC HOOKS work differently. Instead of relying on pitch, they stand out through pattern and timing. If a rhythm makes you tap your foot without thinking, it is doing its job. Bass lines and percussion figures often fill this role in electronic music.

LYRICAL HOOKS anchor a track through language. Repeated phrases or chorus lines become points of reference that listeners latch onto quickly. Even minimal wording can carry a lot of weight when it is placed correctly and repeated with intent.

INSTRUMENTAL HOOKS sit somewhere between melodic and production-focused ideas. These include riffs or synth lines that feel inseparable from the track itself. In electronic music, bright,

repetitive lead lines often take on this role, especially when they are introduced early and reinforced throughout the arrangement.

STRUCTURAL HOOKS rely on repetition and arrangement choices. A sudden change in energy, texture, or section length can signal something familiar is coming back around. Over time, listeners learn these signals and respond to them instinctively.

PRODUCTION HOOKS come from sound design choices rather than composition alone. Distinctive processing, modulation, or vocal effects can make an otherwise simple idea feel unique. In modern electronic production, these elements often blend with melodic or rhythmic hooks rather than standing alone.

STORY-BASED HOOKS appear less often in electronic music, but they still matter when vocals or narrative elements are involved. A late-arriving lyrical shift can reframe the entire track and give listeners a reason to revisit it.

A lot of existing songwriting advice approaches hooks from a broad, genre-agnostic angle. That can be helpful, but it often misses how electronic music is actually built. This article focuses on hooks from the producer's seat, with practical, DAW-oriented thinking that reflects real workflow. Throughout, I encourage thinking of hooks as memorable musical ideas rather than genre clichés, since the same concept can be executed through sound design, instrumentation, or arrangement choices.

Contrast matters more than many producers realize. If the hook blends too closely with the verse or bridge, it never fully steps into focus.

Why Hooks Matter So Much in Electronic Music

Hooks capture attention quickly, which is essential in a streaming environment where listeners decide within seconds if a track earns their time. In electronic genres, where drum patterns and tempos often overlap, hooks are what separate one track from another.

They define a song's signature. When people recall an electronic track, they are usually remembering a specific synth line, vocal phrase, or texture rather than the drum programming underneath it. That recall is what drives recognition.

Strong hooks increase replay value. Repeat listens signal engagement, which feeds algorithmic systems and helps tracks travel further over time. This is one of the quiet mechanics behind long-term performance on playlists.

Hooks also provide structure. Producers who build from loops often struggle to know where a track should go next. Crafting a hook gives the arrangement a destination and makes it easier to plan progression and contrast.

Emotion plays a role here as well. Effective hooks create feelings like excitement, tension, or nostalgia, which is why they translate so well to dance floors and curated playlists. Those emotional responses are what keep people connected beyond a single listen.

In crowded electronic genres, hooks are one of the clearest ways to stand apart. They support DJ performance by making tracks easier to recall and mix during sets. Over time, consistent hook choices also help with artist identity, since fans begin to associate certain melodic or sonic traits with a name.

Hooks now extend beyond streaming platforms. Short, recognizable moments travel easily on social platforms, where brief clips often become entry points for new listeners. In that context, a strong hook can carry a track further than any single release strategy.

Common Mistakes to Avoid When Writing Hooks

One of the fastest ways to weaken a hook is by overcomplicating it. I have found that adding too many notes or layering complex rhythms usually works against

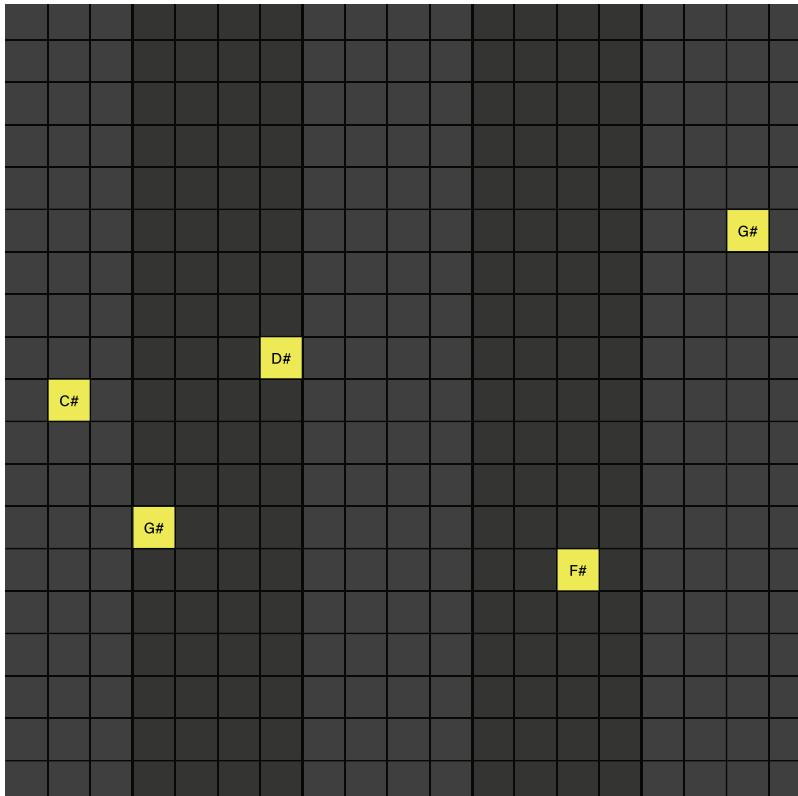
memorability, because the listener has nothing simple to grab onto. Hooks tend to work best when they feel obvious in hindsight, and that clarity disappears quickly once a melody becomes busy or overly technical.

Another issue I see often is hooks that are simply too long. When a phrase stretches on, it stops functioning as a hook and starts behaving like a verse, which blurs the structure of the track. A hook should feel like a quick imprint rather than a full statement, something that lands fast and leaves a trace.

Contrast matters more than many producers realize. If the hook blends too closely with the verse or bridge, it never fully steps into focus. Differences in rhythm, density, pitch range, or energy are what signal to the listener that something important has arrived. Without that separation, even a strong idea can pass unnoticed.

Rhythm and dynamics also play a big role. A solid melodic idea can still fall flat if it does not lock into a clear rhythmic identity or if the surrounding dynamics flatten it out. I also see hooks lose impact when they are buried under excessive effects.





Processing should enhance the idea, not mask it, and clarity usually wins over complexity.

Some ideas simply are not hooks, and forcing them rarely ends well. If a motif does not feel natural after repeated listens, it is often better to set it aside and try something else. Repetition is essential, but repeating a weak idea does not make it stronger. Fresh ears matter too, because after looping something for hours it becomes difficult to judge how it actually lands for someone hearing it the first time.

Finally, space is critical. Overcrowding the arrangement around the hook can drain its impact. Leaving room through arrangement and dynamics allows the hook to breathe and actually feel important when it arrives.

Tools and Resources for Developing Strong Hooks

There are plenty of tools that can support hook writing if you use them with intention. Analysis platforms like Hookpad and TheoryTab are useful for breaking down how popular songs handle melody and harmony, especially when you want to visualize ideas on a piano roll and understand why certain progressions support memorable phrases.

Your DAW remains the main workspace for experimenting. Looping sections, sequencing melodies, and quickly testing arrangement changes make it easier to evaluate whether a hook holds up beyond the initial spark. MIDI controllers and step sequencers can help unlock rhythmic ideas that might not emerge from drawing notes with a mouse.

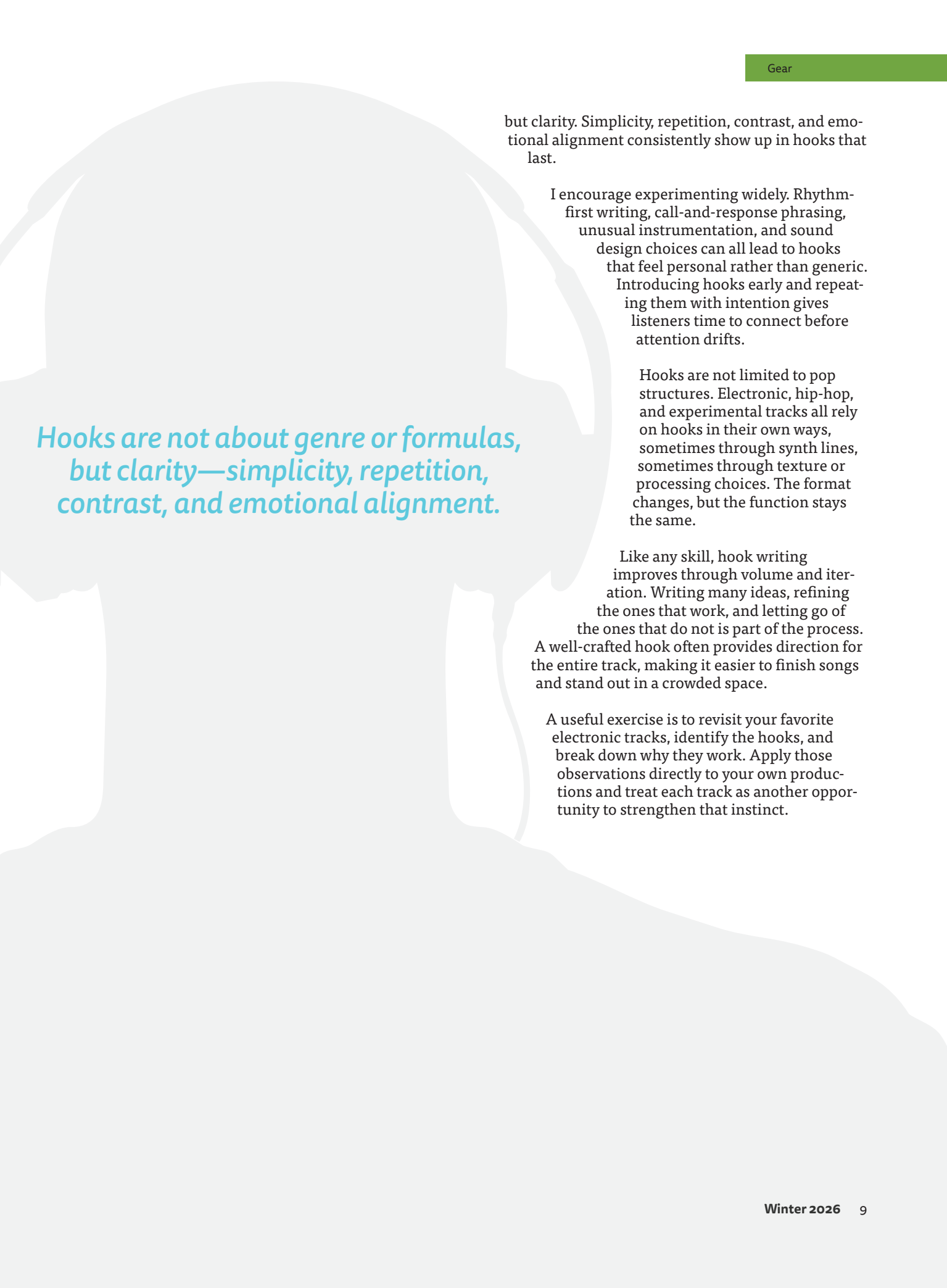
Sound sources matter too. Sample packs and virtual instruments provide starting points that can trigger ideas, whether that comes from a synth lead, a vocal chop, or an unexpected texture. Theory references also help, since understanding intervals, scales, and chord movement gives you more control over how a hook feels emotionally.

Reference tracks are one of the most practical resources available. Listening actively to successful hooks across genres sharpens your instincts and helps you recognize patterns that translate into your own work. Transcribing hooks you admire and identifying what makes them effective builds that understanding even faster.

Feedback is another essential part of the process. Sharing demos with other producers helps break tunnel vision and reveals whether a hook actually lands. Ear training tools can also support this by improving how quickly you recognize intervals and rhythms, which speeds up the writing process over time.

And Finally, How to Write An Amazing Hook

Hooks are the element listeners remember, and they show up in many forms, including melodic phrases, rhythmic patterns, vocal lines, instrumental motifs, or production-driven ideas. What ties them together is not genre,



*Hooks are not about genre or formulas,
but clarity—simplicity, repetition,
contrast, and emotional alignment.*

but clarity. Simplicity, repetition, contrast, and emotional alignment consistently show up in hooks that last.

I encourage experimenting widely. Rhythm-first writing, call-and-response phrasing, unusual instrumentation, and sound design choices can all lead to hooks that feel personal rather than generic. Introducing hooks early and repeating them with intention gives listeners time to connect before attention drifts.

Hooks are not limited to pop structures. Electronic, hip-hop, and experimental tracks all rely on hooks in their own ways, sometimes through synth lines, sometimes through texture or processing choices. The format changes, but the function stays the same.

Like any skill, hook writing improves through volume and iteration. Writing many ideas, refining the ones that work, and letting go of the ones that do not is part of the process. A well-crafted hook often provides direction for the entire track, making it easier to finish songs and stand out in a crowded space.

A useful exercise is to revisit your favorite electronic tracks, identify the hooks, and break down why they work. Apply those observations directly to your own productions and treat each track as another opportunity to strengthen that instinct.



KINGDOM COME DELIVERANCE 2 SOUNDTRACK:

An Exclusive Interview With Composer Jan Valta

With Kingdom Come: Deliverance 2 is officially here and excitement is building for what promises to be one of the most immersive RPGs of the year. A cornerstone of that immersion is the game's massive soundtrack, composed by Jan Valta. Spanning over 400 original tracks and more than 10 hours of music, it's an ambitious work that bridges the medieval world with a modern orchestral approach. In this exclusive interview, Valta breaks down how he created a score that feels authentic yet resonates with contemporary players.

Valta returns after composing the music for the first Kingdom Come game, but this time the scale is even bigger. From refining composition rules to recording with orchestras and choirs, his process reflects an obsession with getting the details right. He shares how certain themes from the original game reappear with new life, creating a sense of continuity that longtime fans will appreciate, while also delivering fresh moments for new players. And yes, there's even a nod to the legendary John Williams as a source of inspiration.

With the game's release tied to a year-long roadmap full of updates and expansions, the soundtrack plays a huge role in defining the experience. Keep reading to find out how one of the most complex video game scores ever came together and why it's set to make *Kingdom Come: Deliverance 2* unforgettable.

Kingdom Come: Deliverance 2 is set in the medieval period. How do you approach composing music that feels authentic to that time but still hits with modern audiences?

Soundtracks for KCD are primarily made of film-like orchestral music. I believe it fits perfectly: although we are creating a story from the 15th century, we create it for a player in the 21st century. And if we think of music being a kind of a language (which I believe it is), we should talk to the player in the language he understands. That will surely be a modern orchestral music rather than a set of gregorian chants, despite the fact the latter would be historically accurate. Also, such period music would fit only into very limited part of places and situations in our game: it would work perfectly for, say, a cemetery around a church in Kuttenberg; but imagine we would try to use the same music for features such as combat, or for all cutscenes – even the scary or thrilling or funny ones!

On the other hand, we always wanted our music to sound ancient in some way. Already during my work on KCD1, I created set of rules which keep the music in this mood (i.e. no ruling duality of minor / major; for that reason no or very little thirds in melodies; non-periodical flow of music etc.) and we kept them in mind in all tracks in the game. For KCD2, I took these rules and refined them a bit.

Along with that ancient feeling, this way we also achieved that the soundtrack – despite its extreme size and extreme variety – remains homogenous.

Were there any historical figures, events, or pieces of medieval music that directly inspired specific tracks in the game?

There is one such specific track in one specific part of Kuttenberg: I found some existing early music from an anonymous 14th/15th century composer, and since it matched all aspects I needed for that

particular place in the game world, I took some elements of it, I put them together with my own elements – and the result is what you'll hear in the game. But since we haven't said what parts of Kuttenberg we have, I'd rather not disclose too much.

Other than that, music for both KCD games was heavily influenced by one figure of truly historical proportions: composer John Williams. Daniel Vávra loves him and so do I. From the very beginning

we both wanted our music to work a bit similar way John Williams' fantastic creations do.

There's only one Williams of course!, but I adore his music so much that heavy influence on me is there, no matter what.

Kingdom Come is known for its realism. How does the music enhance the feeling of being "in the moment" in such a grounded world?

Short answer: wander the game world for couple hours (with music on) and you'll see. A bit longer answer: our music reacts a lot on where you are, what you do, what weather condition / time of the day you're in etc. And when creating music for a specific location, I really took a lot of time to find very specific musical elements which would help build & maintain the atmosphere of that location. I hope players will feel it. And again: music for open world takes about 7 hours of the soundtrack's total time. That puts a lot of variety on the table. In an open-world RPG where you can do literally anything you want, variety of music is a good thing.

How does the music evolve with the player's journey? Are there recurring motifs that change or grow as the story unfolds?

Exactly! There are recurring themes and motifs in KCD2. Some of them were even used in KCD1 (main theme, theme of Henry's parents, themes for Hans Capon, Godwin...) and if you played KCD1, it'll come back to you. It was the same for me as composer: when I worked with these themes again, I felt like meeting old friends after years!

Here it's important to say what I mean if I say "a theme": primarily it's just the melody. Sometimes it's melody with some specific attributes (chords progression, or such things like: Godwin theme is

If music is a kind of language, we should talk to the player in the language he understands.

sung by male choir and/or played by harpsichord). But i.e. the main theme, theme of Henry's parents etc. – to me, all these were just melodies which I took, re-shaped, gave them a completely new feel and purpose – and only then I let them go into the KCD2 world, to live another life there. Sometimes these themes resisted my efforts a bit – maybe just like old friends would do, seeing your new habits. But somehow I always persuaded them.

So, with only few exceptions which I made for dramaturgical reasons, every single music track you'll hear during your adventure in KCD2 was newly designed, composed and produced. I hope players will enjoy it!

Maybe here's the right time to say it: soundtrack for KCD2 consists of 400 tracks. It's over 10 hours of music, all originally composed for KCD2.

What does your creative workflow look like when working on a project of this scale?

This is a wonderful question! But to answer it properly, I would need at least ten times more space than what the overall length of this interview can ever be. But at least some snippets: It needed over 4 years of my work.

About 25% of that time goes for design: going through all the sources of information from other developers in the studio and also talking with them a lot, making spreadsheets and approximations, do a bit of historical research (not necessarily music-related), think and plan without actually writing a single note into the score... If I simplify it, these 25% go first.

To be a professional composer means: you do deliver. Always.

Then there's another 25% of my time which goes for production: preparing orchestrations, organizing the recording schedule and choosing musicians I wish to work with, conducting the orchestra and choir during the actual recording sessions, further recordings with soloists etc. ... But also creating musical transitions (so each track can end smoothly when the game situation asks for it) and overall working with samples... ..and then post-production!, editing, mixing and mastering with our wonderful music sound engineer Ondřej Urban. Btw. this post-prod part was very time consuming this time: music in KCD2 is more complex than in KCD1; and as you can imagine, for any extra bit of com-



Jan Valta working on the score for KDC2

plexity you add, all things become much harder to maintain. These 25% come in last.

And then there's those remaining 50% of my time in between – where I can just sit and compose! Believe it or not, of these three areas, the actual composing is the simplest for me: it's where I feel comfortable.

By the way, another comfortable time was conducting the orchestra and choir: it might look like a dangerous thing to do (there were over 100 people on stage at the same time; and yes, it does cost a fortune). But if you do your homework (music, orchestrations, scores, parts...) properly, it's a piece of cake. And a very delicious one, I might add: musicians in Prague are fantastic!, and to hear your music live for the first time, performed by such elite artists... Well, that's an amazing experience, impossible to describe in words.

Also, we mustn't forget my colleague Adam Sporka who – same as in KCD1 – was responsible for technical implementation of music into the game in KCD2, and he also contributed to its musical content as

additional composer (i.e. you can again look forward to his songs and pub / bath bangers!). We met on some of the design work (yes, those first 25% of my work) but he did so many other things himself! Notably the music engine controlling which music track plays where and when, what are the priorities... etc. I believe doing all this took him about the same amount of time as it took me.

The question asks about a “creative workflow” – well, I did my best but now I’m not sure if I actually answered that! If not, here’s one last thing: if you compose, it goes either the easy way or the hard way. The easy way is: a theme or some other musical idea comes into your mind somehow, out of nowhere (I like to think it’s from above) – and you instantly know it’s good. This happens more often when you don’t work and let your head spinning on its own. But it doesn’t happen with a finger snap, so I don’t rely on it.

If no such inspiration appears, the hard way takes over: you sit, you start with the first tone; you add couple more; you check whether these work together; if not, you change some of them; if yes, you add a bit more new tones. Repeat that – and music starts to exist. (Of course the real composing work is a bit more complex than that but actually that’s the way it happens.)

I believe that to be a professional music composer means: you do deliver. Always, no matter what. Hence, the hard way rules!

What role did live instrumentation play in this soundtrack? Did you work with any unique or rare medieval instruments?

My colleague Adam used live medieval instruments for some of his tracks (actually he played quite some himself); I relied on samples. But for some specific cutscenes, I used elements such as string quartet, female vocal and child’s voice. As I said in the first question, I added the medieval feel into the pot through specific composing rules; adding medieval instruments is of course a great idea (and surely the first one everyone – including me – would come up with) but often it’s just a seasoning, a cherry on the top. The real music happens within: phrase building, voice leading, chords progression, work with rhythm and instrumentation... Simply, work.

Finally, what’s one thing about the Kingdom Come: Deliverance 2 soundtrack that you’re most proud of and can’t wait for players to experience?

As our beloved Luke Dale said in our Announcement Video in April: KCD2 is a behemoth of a game. Similarly, this is a behemoth of a soundtrack: come on, 400 tracks, over 10 hours of original music?!? But despite its size and scope and complexity: every single track was done with care and with love. You bet the same goes for every single thing we have in the game itself! And I believe our fantastic fans as well as new players will feel this. If music will help build that feeling, I’ll be proud as a peacock.

By WILL VANCE

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BARELY ALIVE IGNITES A NEW ERA OF DUBSTEP WITH 360° 'OVERDRIVE' TOUR

BARELY ALIVE are gearing up for one of the most ambitious chapters of their career with the announcement of the 'OVERDRIVE' Tour, a 15+ date headline run that promises to push the boundaries of the modern dubstep experience.

Spanning January through April 2026, the tour brings their forward-thinking vision to some of the country's most iconic venues, transforming clubs, warehouses, and theaters into a fully immersive 360° world of sound and light.

The run launches January 31 at San Francisco's 888 Warehouse, setting the tone for a high-octane journey across the United States. From there, the tour will hit Philadelphia's The Ave, Virginia Beach's Peabody's, and Minneapolis' Fillmore before weaving through Houston, Spokane, and Seattle's WAMU. A massive night awaits at New York City's Webster Hall on March 14, followed by a heavy dose of bass in Denver, Chicago, Pontiac, Fort Lauderdale, Tampa, and Portland. The tour will ultimately culminate in a special 'OVERDRIVE Finale' at an undisclosed location, closing the run with a larger-than-life celebration of BARELY ALIVE's impact on the scene.

Each night will feature a curated lineup of heavy hitters including Hairitage, Tisoki, TYNAN, Oliverse,

and Edison Cole, artists who match the intensity and innovation BARELY ALIVE bring to the stage. "Fans can expect BARELY ALIVE's Overdrive Tour to deliver a next-level experience with its 360° stage design and mind-blowing laser and visual production," the duo shares. "We will unleash a mix of brand-new dubstep alongside nostalgic brostep throwbacks, blending the future and roots of bass music into one explosive set. Surrounded by sound and light, fans will be fully immersed in the music, taking part in an unforgettable experience at the cutting edge of the dubstep scene."

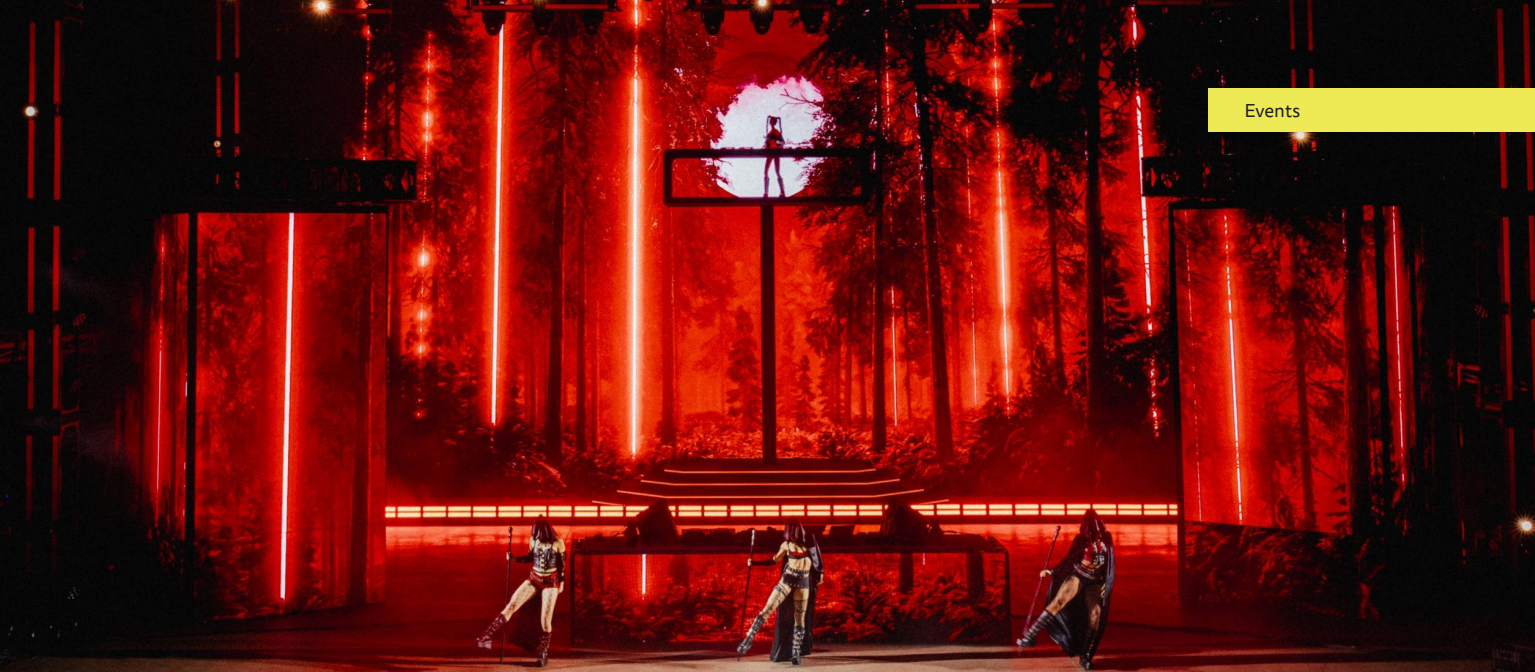
Fans can expect a next-level experience with a 360° stage design and mind-blowing visuals.

Momentum for BARELY ALIVE has skyrocketed over the past year. Their latest single "HANDS UP" became one of the defining moments of Lost Lands, while their official remix of Marshmello, TRICKSTAR, and Lil Jon's "Bad Boys" with YDG further cemented their production prowess. Tracks like "next to me," "don't stop," "chicken jockey," and "hold me" showcase their signature versatility, moving effortlessly between crushing drops and nostalgic callbacks to dubstep's golden era.

With global tour dates ahead, BARELY ALIVE enter 2026 with a renewed sense of purpose. The 'OVERDRIVE' Tour marks the beginning of a new chapter, one defined by experimentation, evolution, and a relentless commitment to shaping the future of bass music.

BY CONNOR PHILLIPS
IMAGE FROM MAGNETIC MAGAZINE





INSIDE DEATHPIXIE'S DEBUT AT RED ROCKS: BLURRING THE LINE BETWEEN DIGITAL AND LIVE

When DEATHPIXIE stepped onto Red Rocks, or rather towered above it, electronic music experienced something unprecedented. As the first virtual DJ to ever “perform” at the amphitheatre, she delivered a spectacle that challenged the definition of live performance while captivating thousands of fans between deadmau5’s sets across two nights.

Her set unfolded like a graphic novel brought to life. A towering 40-foot avatar went super-saiyan against the rock formations, while dancers with swords moved in tightly choreographed arcs, and a live performance from Skylar Grey expanded DEATHPIXIE’s world into something tangible. It was less about a DJ on decks and more about a cohesive visual mythology designed to fill the entire venue.

Less like an animated character, more like an unconventional headliner.

DEATHPIXIE’s popularity has risen sharply, fueled by more than 250,000 monthly listeners, viral clips spreading past 10 million views, and collaborations with major artists like OddKidOut and Meryll. Her musical identity, dark, cinematic, and charged with

emotional tension, translates naturally into a digital persona built for storytelling as much as sound.

While virtual performers are not new, DEATHPIXIE brings a distinctly modern EDM sensibility. She exists at the intersection of animation, production, and narrative-driven visuals, but with a sonic aesthetic rooted in the current rave landscape rather than pop or idol culture. As a result, she feels less like an animated character and more like an unconventional headliner.

The project signals a shift in how audiences may experience electronic music. This entire Red Rocks set was pre-produced, yet its impact was undeniable. It is a reminder that performance can be reimaged through design, scale, and emotional world-building. The question is not whether DEATHPIXIE is “live” by traditional standards, but whether the connection she creates feels real to those in the crowd.

With new music, a growing visual universe, and expanded 2026 live concepts underway, DEATHPIXIE stands at the beginning of a movement. Her Red Rocks debut was not a conclusion; it was a catalyst, one poised to redefine how digital artists shape the next decade of electronic music.

BY CONNOR PHILLIPS
IMAGE FROM MAGNETIC MAGAZINE